

BASAI: Positioning Biologicals as a tool to improve farmer profits and sustainability

As global agriculture pivots toward sustainability, India's biological agri-input sector is entering a defining moment—and BASAI has emerged as the industry's most influential, unifying voice.

In a landscape where biological inputs are increasingly critical for sustainable farming, the Biological Agri Solutions Association of India (BASAI) is positioning itself as the sector's guiding force. Established in 2019 as a not-for-profit under Section 8, BASAI today represents 53 corporate members, multiple farmer groups, and leading national and international CROs—together forming a powerful coalition for change.

The role BASAI plays is vital. Despite growing interest in biologicals, awareness remains low, misconceptions abound, and the market continues to be flooded with counterfeit products masquerading as "bio" solutions. "The lack of scientific understanding and regulatory clarity has held back an industry that could transform Indian farming. Farmers are increasingly using biologics in their toolbox to mitigate effects of climate change, improve fertilizer use efficiency, produce residue free food and regenerate soil compromised for fertility," notes BASAI President Sandeepa Kanitkar. "Our mission is to correct that—through knowledge, collaboration and strong governance."

Over the past few years, the regulatory landscape has begun evolving. Biofertilizers/Organic fertilizers/Biostimulants have entered the Fertilizer Control Order



Vipin Saini
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(FCO 1985), and bio-pesticides have clearer registration pathways under the Central Insecticides Act. Yet the challenges are complex, spanning awareness gaps, quality control, farmer trust, and harmonization with global standards. BASAI was formed precisely to address these systemic issues and to ensure that biological products are seen not as alternatives, but as essential components of modern agriculture as per and Chief Executive Officer Mr Vipin Saini.

ITS VISION IS AMBITIOUS:

- To be the ethical and authoritative voice of the biological agri-input industry
- To partner with the government on compliance and regulatory refinement
- To ensure only safe, high-quality products reach farmers
- To promote sustainable agriculture through balanced use of biologicals, fertilizers, and crop protection
- To coordinate global best practices and steward the industry's long-term growth

This vision aligns strongly with India's policy push toward organic and natural farming. Flagship schemes—from Paramparagat Krishi Vikas Yojana (PKVY) to MOVCDNER in the Northeast—are promoting organic clusters, financial assistance for bio-inputs, and strengthened certification frameworks. Start-ups too are being nurtured through the Innovation and Agri-Entrepreneurship programme under RKVY, which has already supported more than 1,700 agri-innovators.

Meanwhile, major institutions like ICAR and SAUs are accelerating biopesticide research, enhancing shelf life, and expanding production infrastructure. These initiatives collectively create fertile ground for BASAI's advocacy.

Yet BASAI's leadership believes that sustainable agriculture must progress beyond policy and production. "Biologicals will redefine the future of Indian farming, but only if farmers trust the ecosystem," says another senior member. "Our goal is to make biological inputs mainstream, credible and globally competitive."